

HEATER - Connor's To-Do List

The only tasks that need YOU. Everything else (the build) is automated. Do 1-5 to launch the paid beta with your 12 leaguemates. 6-8 are for later. [ASK ME] = I do it for you - just say so.
Updated 2026-06-21.

1. Clerk - the login system (~10 min)

<https://dashboard.clerk.com>

1. Sign up, then click Create application. Name it HEATER. Turn on Email + Google. Create.
2. Left menu > API keys. Copy the Publishable key (starts pk_). Keep it for Task 4.
3. Left menu > Domains. Copy the Frontend API URL (<https://...clerk.accounts.dev>). Keep it for Task 3.
(Your admin User ID comes later, in Task 5, after you first sign in.)

2. Stripe - the \$7.99/mo subscription (~15 min)

<https://dashboard.stripe.com>

Keep the top-right toggle on TEST mode for the beta (no real charges).

1. Create/sign in. Product catalog > Add product. Name: HEATER Pro.
2. Price: 7.99 USD, Recurring, Monthly. Set Free trial = 7 days. Save.
3. Open the product. Copy the Price ID (starts price_). Keep for Task 3.
4. Open the API keys page below. Copy the Secret key (starts sk_test_). Keep for Task 3.
<https://dashboard.stripe.com/test/apikeys>
5. Developers > Webhooks > Add endpoint. URL = your Railway API URL + /api/billing/webhook
(you get that URL in Task 3 - come back and finish this).
6. Choose these 4 events, then Add endpoint:
checkout.session.completed, customer.subscription.created,
customer.subscription.updated, customer.subscription.deleted
7. Copy the endpoint Signing secret (starts whsec_). Keep for Task 3.

3. Put the backend online - Railway (~20 min; the trickiest - do it with me)

DONE: I added the deploy files (api/Dockerfile + start-api.sh). [ASK ME] Ping me to do this step together.

<https://railway.app>

1. Sign in with GitHub.
2. New Project > Deploy from GitHub repo > choose HEATER_v1.0.0.
3. Service > Settings > Build: set Dockerfile Path = api/Dockerfile
4. Service > Settings > Deploy: Start Command = sh start-api.sh Healthcheck Path = /healthz
5. Settings > Networking > Generate Domain. Copy URL (<https://...railway.app>) = your API URL (Tasks 2 & 4).
6. Settings > add a Volume, mount path: /app/data
7. Variables > add:
MULTI_USER = 1
CLERK_ISSUER = <Task 1 Frontend API URL>
YAHOO_TOKEN_JSON = <your Yahoo token - [ASK ME], I'll get it for you>
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY = <Task 2>
STRIPE_PRO_PRICE_ID = <Task 2>
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET = <Task 2>
HEATER_API_CORS_ORIGINS = <Task 4 Vercel URL - add after Task 4>
HEATER_ADMIN_CLERK_IDS = <your User ID - add in Task 5>
8. First boot warms the data (a few minutes). Ready when /healthz shows healthy.

4. Put the website online - Vercel (~10 min)

<https://vercel.com>

1. Sign in with GitHub.
2. Add New > Project > import HEATER_v1.0.0.
3. Set Root Directory to: web
4. Environment Variables > add:
NEXT_PUBLIC_CLERK_PUBLISHABLE_KEY = <Task 1>

NEXT_PUBLIC_HEATER_LIVE = 1

HEATER_API_BASE = <Task 3 Railway API URL>

5. Deploy. Copy your site URL (https://...vercel.app).

6. Back in Railway > Variables: set HEATER_API_CORS_ORIGINS = your Vercel URL.

7. Back in Stripe (Task 2, step 5): finish the webhook URL using your Railway API URL.

5. Add your 12 + test payment (~20 min)

1. Share your Vercel site URL with your 12 leaguemates; each signs up.

2. Sign in yourself once. In Clerk > Users, click your name, copy your User ID (starts user_).

In Railway > Variables, set HEATER_ADMIN_CLERK_IDS = that ID. (It redeploys.)

3. Send me each person's name + their fantasy team name.

[ASK ME] I'll link each login to the right team (easiest + safest).

4. Test billing: on the site click Upgrade > pay with test card 4242 4242 4242 4242,

any future date, any 3-digit code. You should become Pro. -> Beta is live.

LATER - only when we scale up / go public (not needed for the beta)

6. (Scaling) Bigger database + a decision

1. Railway > New > Database > Add PostgreSQL. Tell me when it's added (I do the rest).

2. Tell me which league sites to support, in order: Yahoo, ESPN, Sleeper, CBS, manual upload.

I need #2 before I can build multi-league support.

7. (Optional) Let HEATER set lineups in Yahoo

Only if you want the app to WRITE to Yahoo. The beta works read-only without this.

<https://developer.yahoo.com/apps/>

1. Open your HEATER app > API Permissions > Fantasy Sports > check Read/Write > Save.

2. Tell me - I'll refresh the Yahoo connection.

8. (Public launch) Your own web address

1. Buy a domain at any registrar (e.g. Namecheap).

2. Vercel > your project > Settings > Domains > Add > follow its DNS steps.

3. Tell me the domain - I'll allow it on the backend.

Stuck on any step? Just ask me. I can also do any [ASK ME] item for you.